MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CARTRIDGE, 5.56MM: PLASTIC, BALL, PRACTICE, M862

This specification is approved for use by the U.S. Army Armament, Munitions and Chemical Command and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification establishes the performance, firing and quality assurance requirements for the assembly, testing, inspection and packaging for the Cartridge, 5.56mm: Plastic, Ball, Practice, M862.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards and handbooks. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the following specifications and standards of the issue listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) specified in the solicitation, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-A-2550	-	Ammunition, General Specifications for
MIL-I-45208	-	Inspection System Requirement
MIL-I-45607	-	Inspection Equipment, Acquisition, Maintenance and Disposition of
MIL-A-48078	-	Ammunition, Standard Quality Specifications for

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

FSC 1305

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander, US Army Armament Research and Development Center, Attn. DRSMC-QA, Dover, New Jersey 07801 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

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MIL-STD-109	-	Quality Assurance Terms and Definitions
MIL-STD-636	-	Visual Inspection Standards for Small Arms Ammunition through Caliber .50
MIL-STD-644	-	Visual Inspection Standards and Inspection Procedures for Inspection of Packaging, Packing and Marking of Small Arms Ammunition
MIL-STD-1168	-	Lot Numbering of Ammunition

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

DRAWINGS (see 6.5)

US ARMY ARMAMENT RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT CENTER (ARDC)

PRODUCT AND PACKAGING DRAWINGS

9341508	-	Cartridge, 5.56mm: Plastic Ball, Practice, M862
9345011	-	Combination of Adopted Items (Cartridge: 5.56mm, Plastic, Ball, Practice, M862)
7643674	-	Classification of Cartridge Case Defects
11833491	-	Bolt, Automatic Weapon: Practice, XM2

PUBLICATIONS

Ammunition Ballistic Acceptance Test Methods, Test Procedures for 5.56mm Cartridges (SCATP 5.56)

(Copies of specifications, standards, handbooks, and publications required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.1.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the reference cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. Materials shall be in accordance with the applicable drawings and specifications.

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3.2 Cartridge. The cartridge shall comply with all requirements specified on drawing (Dwg.) 9341508, all associated drawings and with all requirements specified in applicable specifications and standards.

3.3 Propellant. The propellant shall be Bofors NC688-PK2.

3.4 Residual stress. The cartridge case shall not split when subjected to a 1% mercurous nitrate solution for 15 minutes.

3.5 Waterproofness. The cartridge shall not release more than one bubble of air when subjected to an internal pressure of 13.8 kilopascals (kpa) minimum for 15 seconds minimum.

3.6 Accuracy. The average of the mean radii of all ten round targets, at a distance of 25 meters from the muzzle, shall not exceed 3.0 cm.

3.7 Velocity. The mean velocity of the cartridge, conditioned at 21° Centigrade (C), shall be 1,500 meters per second (mps) plus or minus 70 mps at 2.5M from the muzzle of the weapon. The standard deviation of the cartridge velocity shall not exceed 25 mps.

3.8 Chamber pressure. The mean peak chamber pressure of the cartridge, conditioned at 21°C for 20 minutes minimum, and measured at the case mouth using the piezoelectric transducer type specified by the Government, shall not exceed 220.6 megapascals (mpa). The peak chamber pressure of any individual cartridge shall not exceed 241.3 mpa.

3.9 Temperature stability. The cartridges conditioned and fired at the temperature extremes specified below shall be in accordance with 3.9.1, 3.9.2, and 3.10.

a. Conditioned at 40°C for not less than one hour and fired at that temperature.

b. Conditioned at -20°C for not less than one hour and fired at that temperature.

3.9.1 Velocity. The mean velocity shall not decrease by more than 50 mps from the mean velocity at 21°C. Any increase in velocity is acceptable.

3.9.2 Chamber pressure. The mean chamber pressure shall not increase by more than 20.7 mpa from the mean chamber pressure at 21°C. Any decrease in chamber pressure is acceptable.

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3.10 Function and casualty. The cartridge shall function at ambient temperature and under the temperature conditions specified in 3.9.

3.11 Cyclic rate. The cartridges shall operate the M16 rifle at a cyclic rate of not less than 600 cartridges per minute, or more than 900 cartridges per minute.

3.12. Data requirements. The contractor shall generate and deliver data in accordance with the DD Form 1423 in the contract. This shall include submission of the detailed inspection plan for this item for review by the Government technical agency.

3.13. First article inspection. This specification contains technical provisions for the first article inspection. Requirements for the submission of first article samples by the contractor shall be as specified in the contract.

3.14 Workmanship. The requirements for workmanship shall be as specified on applicable drawings, specifications and in accordance with the following:

3.14.1 Foreign matter. The cartridge shall be free of corrosion, stains, discoloration, dirt, and smears of lacquer.

3.14.2 Metal integrity. the cartridge shall be free of metal defects which include but are not limited to: folds, wrinkles, deep draw scratches, scaly metal, dents, perforations, and surface or subsurface splits.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, as approved by the Government. In addition, the Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the acceptance test plan where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements. Reference shall be made to MIL-STD-109 to define terms used herein. The provisions of MIL-A-2550 shall apply.

4.1.1 Classification of inspection. The following types of inspections shall be conducted as specified herein.

a. First Article Inspection (see 4.2.1).
b. Quality Conformance Inspection (see 4.3).

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4.2 First article inspection.

4.2.1 First article sample. At the beginning of regular production, a sample of cartridges shall be submitted in accordance with contract requirements. The sample shall be manufactured using the same materials, equipment, processes and procedures as will be used in regular production. All parts and materials, including packaging and packing, shall be the same as used for regular production and shall be obtained from the same source of supply.

4.2.1.1 Examination and test. The sample shall be inspected for all requirements of Table I and to any or all of the requirements of the applicable drawings and specifications at a Government laboratory or such other facility specified in the contract.

4.2.1.2 First article sample failure. Failure of the sample to comply with requirements of the drawings and specifications shall result in sample disapproval. Determination as to acceptability of any initial production sample shall be based upon results of initial tests only, and no second tests shall be permitted on that initial production sample. MIL-A-48078 shall apply.

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TABLE I. FIRST ARTICLE INSPECTION

DOD-C-70463(AR)

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER
	Cartridge, 5.56mm: Plastic, Ball, Practice, M862				9341508
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
	Ballistic Tests				
	Velocity (all temperatures)	60		3.7	4.4.4
	Chamber pressure (all temperatures)	60		3.8	4.4.5
	Accuracy	90		3.6	4.4.3
	Other Firing Tests				
	Function & Casualty (all temperature)	660		3.9 & 3.10	4.4.7
	Examination for defects	910		3.2	4.3.4.1
	Other Tests				
	Residual stress	20		3.4	4.4.1
	Waterproof	20		3.5	4.4.4

NOTES:

DRSMC-OA (D) Form 160, 1 Aug 83 replaces edition of 1 Jul 77 which may be used until exhausted.

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4.3 Inspection provisions.

4.3.1 Lot.

4.3.1.1 Submission of product. The product shall be submitted in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.3.1.2 Lot identification. Each lot of ammunition shall be identified as to type, caliber and model, as well as with a lot number in accordance with MIL-STD-1168. Each lot shall be further identified by a Federal Stock Number assigned by the procuring activity.

4.3.2 Examination. One hundred percent examination shall be performed for all critical defects. Examination for major and minor defects shall be performed on a class basis in accordance with the classification of defects, Table II, using applicable sampling plans and acceptance criteria of MIL-STD-105. The Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) for the major class shall be 0.25 percent and the AQL for the minor class shall be 1.50 percent. All non-conforming cartridges shall be rejected.

4.3.2.1 Classification of defects. The classification of defects shall be as specified in Table II.

4.3.3 Tests. The tests listed in Table II shall be conducted in accordance with the methods and procedures specified in 4.4.

4.3.3.1 Test samples. The quantities for the various tests shall be as specified in Table II. Only cartridges having met the visual requirements shall be used in the ballistic tests, and shall have been selected in such a manner that the sample is representative of the entire lot. The cartridges shall be thoroughly mixed before being divided into samples for the various tests.

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TABLE II. QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 2		DRAWING NUMBER
4.3.4.1	Cartridge, 5.56mm: Plastic, Ball, Practice, M862				9341508
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
	See note 1 below				
CRITICAL	100% Examination				
1.	Case split in K, L, or M location		100%	3.2	Visual
2.	Perforated case		100%	3.2	Visual
3.	Primer cocked		100%	3.2	Visual
4.	Primer inverted		100%	3.2	Visual
MAJOR	AQL = .25%				
101.	Cartridge corroded or stained		.25%	3.2	Visual
102.	head round		.25%	3.2	Visual
103.	Case dent		.25%	3.2	Visual
104.	Case split in I, S, or J location		.25%	3.2	Visual
105.	Case draw scratch		.25%	3.2	Visual
106.	Beveled underside of head		.25%	3.2	Visual
107.	Case metal scaly		.25%	3.2	Visual
108.	No chamfer on head (rim)		.25%	3.2	Visual
109.	Primer loose		.25%	3.2	Visual
110.	Lubrication missing		.25%	3.2	Visual
111.	Primer missing		.25%	3.2	Visual
MINOR	AQL = 1.5% 1/				
201.	Cartridge discolored or dirty		1.5%	3.2	Visual
202.	Case scratch		1.5%	3.2	Visual
203.	Case fold		1.5%	3.2	Visual

NOTES:

1/ Refer to MIL-STD-636 (NATO caliber 7.62mm section) for visual defect standards.

DRSMC-QA (D) Form 160, 1 Aug 83 replaces edition of 1 Jul 77 which may be used until exhausted.

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TABLE II. QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 2 OF 2		DRAWING NUMBER
4.3.4.1	Cartridge, 5.56mm: Plastic, Ball, Practice, M862				9341508
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
204.	Case wrinkle		1.5%	3.2	Visual
205.	Case buckle		1.5%	3.2	Visual
206.	Case bulge		1.5%	3.2	Visual
207.	Illegible or missing head stamp		1.5%	3.2	Visual
208.	Defective head		1.5%	3.2	Visual
209.	Defective mouth		1.5%	3.2	Visual
210.	Bullet dent		1.5%	3.2	Visual
211.	Bullet scratch		1.5%	3.2	Visual
212.	Bullet, upset (crooked) point		1.5%	3.2	Visual
213.	Nicked or dented primer		1.5%	3.2	Visual
214.	Primer, defective crimp		1.5%	3.2	Visual

NOTES:

DRSMC-OA (D) Form 160, 1 Aug 83 replaces edition of 1 Jul 77 which may be used until exhausted.

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CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER
4.3.4.2	Cartridge, 5.56mm: Plastic, Ball, Practice, M862				9341508
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
		1st sample			
	Ballistic Tests				
	Velocity 4/	20		3.7	4.4.4
	Chamber pressure 4/	20		3.8	4.4.5
	Accuracy 3/	90		3.6	4.4.3
	Other Firing Tests				
	Function & Casualty (all temperature) 5/	660		3.9 & 3.10	4.4.7, 4.4.8
	Examination for defects	830		3.2	4.3.4.1
	Other Tests				
	Residual stress (Mercurous Nitrate) 1/	20		3.4	4.4.1
	Waterproof 2/	20		3.5	4.4.4

NOTES:

DRSMC-OA (D) Form 160, 1 Aug 83 replaces edition of 1 Jul 77 which may be used until exhausted.

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NOTES:

1/ Failure of two or more cartridges to comply with the applicable requirement shall be cause for rejection of the lot. If one cartridge fails in the first test, a second sample consisting of double the number of cartridges in the first sample shall be tested. If any failing cartridges are found in the second sample, the lot shall be rejected.

2/ Failure of five or more cartridges to comply with the applicable requirement shall be cause for rejection of the lot. If more than two but less than five cartridges fail in the first test, a second sample consisting of double the number of cartridges in the first sample shall be tested. The lot shall be rejected if in the combined first and second sample, five or more cartridges fail to comply with the applicable requirement.

3/ Failure of the cartridges to comply with the applicable requirement shall be cause for rejection of the lot subject to testing of a second sample consisting of double the quantity of cartridges used in the first test. Failure of the cartridges in the second sample to comply with the applicable requirement shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4/ Failure of the cartridges in any sample to comply with the applicable requirement shall be cause for rejection of the lot subject to testing of a second sample consisting of double the quantity of cartridges used in the first test. Failure of the cartridges of the second sample to comply with the applicable requirement shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

5/ The lot shall be rejected when either stoppages or firing defects observed in the function and casualty test exceed the acceptance number for the cumulative sample of Table III. If the number of stoppages or defects found in the first test exceeds the acceptance number for the first sample, but is equal to or less than the acceptance number for the cumulative sample, a second sample, consisting of the quantities specified under function and casualty test shall be fired. If the total number of stoppages or defects in the combined first and second sample exceeds the acceptance number for the cumulative sample, the lot shall be rejected. If, in testing a second sample, defects other than those for which the second sample is being tested should occur to the extent that they exceed the acceptance number for the cumulative sample, the lot shall be rejected.

4.3.3.2 Firing defects. Firing defects and acceptance numbers shall be as specified in Table IIIA and IIIB.

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TABLE IIIA

Defects	Acceptance First Sample	Acceptance Cumulative (1st&2nd Sample)
1. Misfire 6/		
a. No vent hole	0	-
b. Other	1	2
2. Bullet remaining in bore 1/	0	-
3. Primer Leak:		
a. Perforation in firing pin indent in primer cup 2/	0	-
b. Escape of gas through primer cup other than 3a. above	1	2
c. Escape of gas around primer cup 5/	12	32
d. Loose primer 7/	1	2
e. Blown primer 7/	0	1
f. Dropped primer 7/	0	1
4. Case casualties		
a. Longitudinal split 3/		
(1) Neck and shoulder (I & S)	12	32
(2) Body (J)	2	4
(3) Body (K)	0	1
(4) To head (L)	0	1
(5) Through head (M)	0	1
b. Circumferential rupture 3/		
(1) Partial, shoulder or body (J & S)	4	10
(2) Partial, body (K)	0	1
(3) Partial, head (L)	0	1
(4) Complete	0	1

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Table IIIB

FUNCTION AND CASUALTY 4/

First Sample

Temperature	Sample Size	Accept	Reject
Ambient	330	3	7
High 40°C	165		
Low -20°C	165		
Combined High & Low	330	7	11

Second Sample

Temperature	Sample Size	Combined 1st & 2nd Sample Accept	Reject
Ambient	330	8	9
40°C	165		
-20°C	165		
Combined High & Low	330	18	19

NOTES:

1/ No second sample permitted. Lot shall be rejected.

2/ Prior to the testing of the second sample, the firing pin of the specified rifle(s) in which the defect originally occurred shall be replaced with a new firing pin. If an additional pirmer perforation is found in the second sample. the lot shall be rejected.

3/ For location of defects indicated by letters in parentheses, see Drawing C7643674.

4/ All stoppages attributable to the ammunition, with the exception of misfire, complete rupture or failure to extract, observed in all tests shall be included.

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5/ Of the cartridges in which this defect occurs, not more than 8 in the first sample nor more than 20 in the cumulative sample shall exhibit escape of gas around 50% or more than 50% of the periphery.

6/ Each cartridge that misfires shall be disassembled and examined for presence of vent hole in primer pocket. If vent hole is missing, the lot shall be rejected with no second sample permitted.

7/ Loose primer. Looseness, but not so as to permit the fired primer to fall from the primer pocket.

Blown primer. A primer which, when the cartridge is fired, is separated completely from the head of the cartridge case, and both the head of the case and the primer pocket are grossly distorted and deformed. The severity of this condition is such that it is readily detectable with the naked eye.

Dropped primer. A primer which falls from the primer pocket after the cartridge is fired.

4.3.4 Packaging, packing and marking inspection. During or immediately prior to the packaging operation, 100% examination of the cartridges shall be performed to ascertain that the cartridge type conforms to the drawing. Occurrence of a high pressure test, dummy or blank cartridge shall be classed as a critical defect. Occurrence of any type other than those listed shall be classed as a major defect. All nonconforming cartridges shall be rejected. Inspection for packaging, packing, and marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-644 as applicable to the drawing.

4.3.5 Inspection equipment. All test and inspection equipment shall be approved by the government. Unless otherwise specified, acquisition, maintenance and disposition of inspection equipment shall be in accordance with MIL-I-45607 and MIL-I-45208.

4.4 Methods of inspection.

4.4.1 Residual stress (mercurous nitrate). The test shall be conducted in accordance with SCATP-5.56.

4.4.2 Waterproof. The test shall be conducted in accordance with SCATP-5.56.

4.4.3 Accuracy. The test shall be conducted in accordance with SCATP-5.56, except that the Mean Radius shall be recorded to the nearest tenth of a centimeter. A Government approved test barrel fitted to a test action shall be used.

4.4.4 Velocity. The test shall be conducted in accordance with SCATP-5.56. A Government approved test barrel fitted to a test action shall be used.

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4.4.5 Chamber pressure. The test shall be conducted in accordance with SCATP-5.56 with the exception that Gage 6211 shall be used. A Government approved test barrel fitted to a test action shall be used.

4.4.6 Temperature. The test shall be conducted in accordance with SCATP-5.56. The weapon in which these tests are fired shall be at room temperature.

4.4.6.1 Low temperature test. The test sample shall be stored at minus 20°C, plus or minus 2 degrees, for not less than 1 hour and shall be fired at that temperature.

4.4.6.2 High temperature test. The test sample shall be stored at 40°C, plus or minus 2 degrees, for not less than 1 hour and shall be fired at that temperature.

4.4.8 Function and Casualty. The test shall be conducted in accordance with SCATP-5.56 and 4.4.8. Three M16 Rifles and three bolts, automatic weapon: practice, XM2 (Dwg. 11833491) shall be used. An equal number of rounds shall be fired in each in bursts of approximately 5 rounds as specified in Table IIIA.

4.4.9 Defect penalty. In any ballistic test, except function and casualty, in which the occurrence of a firing defect prevents the obtaining of a reliable result for the characteristic being tested, an additional shot shall be fired. That particular test shall not be penalized, but the acceptance or initial production sample shall be penalized for such defects in accordance with Table III.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packing. The cartridges shall be packed in accordance with Drawing FA9345011.

5.2 Marking and labeling. Packing boxes shall be marked and labeled in accordance with applicable drawing cited in 5.1.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The cartridges covered by this specification are intended for use in the M16 Rifle.

6.2 Ordering data. Ordering data should include:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.

b. Type and level of packing for the cartridges.

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c. Provision for submission of Inspection Equipment Designs.

d. Provision for submission of detailed inspection plan for the cartridge (see 6.7).

e. Provisons for the submission of acceptance inspection results for each lot of ammunition presented to the Government (see 6.6).

6.3 Submission of inspection equipment designs for approval. Submit inspection equipment designs as required to Commander, ARDC, ATTN: DRSMC-QAF-I(D), Dover, NJ 07801.

6.4 Hazard notice. The cartridge described herein and some of its components are flammable or explosive and consequently present hazards in manufacture, handling, storage and shipment. The contractor should recognize these hazards and take appropriate measures to prevent fire, explosion, adverse environment, rough handling, corrosive atmosphere, and electrically indicated incidents. Such measures shall include the employment of any effective safety program that addresses the inherent hazards associated with the cartridge.

6.5 Drawings. Drawings listed in Section 2 of this specification under the heading US Army Armament Research and Development Center (ARDC) may also include drawings prepared by and identified as US Army Armament Research and Development Command (ARRADCOM), Edgewood Arsenal, Frandfort Arsenal, Rock Island Arsenal or Picatinny Arsenal drawings. Technical data originally prepared by these activities is now under the cognizance of ARDC.

6.6 Submission of test data. In addition to the normal distribution of records, when the cartridge is procured by the US Army, one (1) copy of all ballistic data and the ammunition data card for each lot shall be forwarded to: Commander, ARDC, ATTN; DRSMC-QAF-S(D), Dover, NJ 07801

6.7 Submission of detailed inspection plan for review. The detailed inspection plan for the cartridge shall be submitted to Commander, ARDC, ATTN: DRSMC-QAF(D), Dover, NJ 07801. Submission shall be 30 days after specification is made contractual. All changes to the plan shall be submitted to the above address for review prior to implementation.

Custodian:
Army-AR

Preparing activity:
Army-AR

Project (1305-A962)

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